verification is essential to confirm that the provider fully understands and is agreeable to the terms and conditions outlined in the contract.

This chapter serves as a guide to provider contract tests, with a particular focus on the movies API, which was initially introduced in chapter 4. Before explaining the hands-on part, we provide some guidelines in writing provider contract tests. We then look into how you can pull the contract generated by consumers from a central repository, such as a Pact Broker, and subsequently guide you through the process of verifying the contents of the contract and publishing the results.

This chapter is still part of the CDCT approach, even though we guide you with the provider tests. It's not to be confused with the provider-driven contract testing (PDCT) approach, which we explore in chapter 11.

By the end of this chapter, you'll have more insights into the inner workings of CDCT, from the perspective of both consumers and providers, giving you more confidence to introducing contract testing to your teams.

6.1 Guidelines in writing provider contract tests

Similar to consumer contract tests, there are also a few guidelines when writing provider contract tests. Before you start the process of writing provider tests, the provider API should be available and ready to be tested because we'll be running the tests against the real provider API and not a mock one. In this section, we discuss some recommended practices in writing provider contract tests and cover topics such as the following:

- The focus of a provider contract test
- Using provider states effectively
- Using can-i-deploy to verify that you can safely deploy to production

6.1.1 The focus of a provider contract test

The primary focus of a provider contract test is to verify the contract that the consumer generated. Contract testing tools, such as Pact, provide a framework for allowing data providers to pull the contract and replay the